

Marketing Strategy Playbook

MARKETING STRATEGY & PLAYBOOK

Consumer Electronics Growth Challenge

1. Purpose

This document explains how the company approaches marketing, customer acquisition, retention, product promotion, campaign planning, and marketing performance.

Marketing exists to create measurable commercial value. It is not treated simply as an awareness function or a spending centre. The company expects marketing activity to connect to:

Demand

Customers

Products

Sales

Retention

Revenue

Long-term customer value

Actual campaign-level numbers should be obtained from the quantitative marketing datasets.

2. Marketing Role Within the Business

Marketing supports the business across several stages of the customer relationship:

Awareness

Acquisition

Conversion

Product adoption

Cross-selling

Retention

Reactivation

Marketing therefore interacts with:

Sales

Product

Customer experience

Finance

Operations

A marketing decision can create downstream consequences for the rest of the business.

3. Marketing Objectives

The company's marketing activity can pursue several different objectives.

Primary objectives

Acquire new customers

Generate product demand

Increase sales

Improve conversion

Increase repeat purchases

Reactivate inactive customers

Increase cross-selling

Support product launches

Support seasonal demand

Build brand awareness

Different campaigns can pursue different objectives. A campaign should therefore be evaluated according to what it was designed to achieve.

4. Campaign Types

The company uses several broad campaign categories.

Acquisition campaigns — Designed to introduce the company or its products to potential new customers.

Product promotion campaigns — Designed to generate demand for specific products.

Seasonal campaigns — Designed around periods of increased consumer purchasing activity.

Retention campaigns — Designed to encourage existing customers to purchase again.

Cross-sell campaigns — Designed to introduce complementary products to existing customers.

Reactivation campaigns — Designed to bring previously active customers back into the purchasing relationship.

Brand awareness campaigns — Designed to increase awareness and consideration rather than immediately maximise transactions.

5. Acquisition Marketing

Acquisition marketing focuses on customers who have not previously generated recognised purchases. Potential acquisition mechanisms include:

Product advertising

Marketplace promotion

Digital advertising

Social media

Search

Promotional offers

Regional campaigns

Segment-specific campaigns

Acquisition should not be judged solely on the number of customers acquired. Important questions include:

What does each customer cost?

What products do they purchase?

Do they purchase again?

What is their future value?

Which customer segments are being acquired?

Can acquisition be scaled economically?

6. Retention Marketing

Retention marketing targets existing customers. Potential objectives include:

- Repeat purchase
- Product replacement
- Cross-selling
- Upselling
- Loyalty
- Customer engagement

Retention can be attractive because the company already possesses information about the customer. However, not every repeat purchase requires marketing intervention. Some customers would have purchased regardless. Therefore, the company is interested in incremental impact rather than simply attributed revenue.

7. Reactivation Marketing

Reactivation targets customers whose relationship with the company has weakened. Potential targets include:

- At-risk customers
- Lapsed customers
- Previously valuable customers
- Customers with relevant product replacement opportunities

Potential mechanisms include:

- Personalised offers
- Product reminders
- New-product communication
- Complementary-product recommendations
- Limited-time incentives

Reactivation should be targeted according to customer history. Sending the same message to every inactive customer is unlikely to be optimal.

8. Cross-Sell Marketing

Cross-selling attempts to increase the number of relevant products purchased by an existing customer. Potential product relationships include:

Cross-sell marketing can increase:

- Units per order
- Basket value
- Product penetration
- Customer value

However, relevance is essential. A customer should not be targeted with products that have little relationship to their needs.

9. Product Marketing

Product campaigns should reflect the role of the product.

A broad consumer product may support acquisition.

A specialist product may benefit from targeted marketing.

A complementary accessory may be better suited to cross-selling.

A declining product may require repositioning rather than simply additional promotional spend.

A growing product may justify additional investment only if the company can capture the market opportunity efficiently.

10. Segmented Marketing

The company has three broad customer segments:

Students

Young Professionals

Creators / Gamers

Marketing should recognise that different groups may respond differently.

Students — potential messaging

Value

Convenience

Portability

Practicality

Young Professionals — potential messaging

Productivity

Convenience

Quality

Connected lifestyle

Creators / Gamers — potential messaging

Performance

Customisation

Technology

Specialist use cases

These are starting hypotheses. Actual customer behaviour should determine whether a segment-specific strategy is justified.

11. Lifecycle Marketing

Marketing can be aligned to the customer lifecycle.

No Purchase — Acquisition.

New — Onboarding and second-purchase development.

Active — Cross-sell and repeat purchase.

At Risk — Retention / reactivation.

Lapsed — Targeted reactivation.

Long Lapsed — Selective re-engagement.

This framework prevents the company from treating every customer as though they require the same marketing intervention.

12. Marketing Funnel

The marketing funnel can be understood as:

Different campaigns may influence different stages. A campaign producing awareness should not necessarily be judged using the same immediate revenue metric as a conversion campaign. However, the company ultimately expects marketing activity to connect to measurable business outcomes.

13. Campaign Planning

A campaign should have a clearly defined:

Objective

Target audience

Product or proposition

Channel

Budget

Duration

Expected outcome

Measurement approach

Before launching a campaign, the company should understand what success means. A campaign without a defined objective is difficult to evaluate.

14. Marketing Budget Allocation

Marketing budget should be treated as a scarce resource. The company can allocate spending across:

Acquisition

Retention

Product promotion

Cross-sell

Reactivation

Seasonal campaigns

Brand activity

The strategic question is not:

“How much can we spend?”

It is:

“Where does the next unit of spending create the greatest incremental value?”

15. Efficiency vs Scale

Marketing performance has two important dimensions.

Efficiency — How much commercial output is produced relative to marketing expenditure.

Scale — How much total commercial impact the activity can produce.

A highly efficient campaign may have limited scale. A large campaign may have weaker efficiency but significant total impact. Therefore:

High ROAS $\neq$ automatically the best campaign.

High revenue $\neq$ automatically the best campaign.

The company evaluates both efficiency and scale.

16. Incrementality

One of the most important marketing concepts is incrementality. Attributed revenue does not necessarily equal incremental revenue. A customer may have purchased without seeing the campaign. Therefore, the company should distinguish between:

Attributed outcome — Revenue or orders associated with a campaign under the attribution framework.

Incremental outcome — Additional revenue or orders caused by the campaign that would not otherwise have occurred.

Where possible, marketing decisions should focus on incremental impact.

17. Attribution

The company's campaign performance layer uses a declared attribution framework. Where sufficient information exists, campaign attribution follows a last-touch style logic. This is useful for operational reporting.

However, attribution has limitations. It does not automatically prove:

Causation

Incrementality

Long-term customer value

Participants should therefore avoid treating attributed revenue as unquestionable causal revenue.

18. Marketing and Channels

Marketing and sales channels are related but not identical. A campaign may influence a customer who eventually purchases through:

Company Website

Amazon

Flipkart

Offline Retail

Therefore:

This distinction matters when evaluating marketing effectiveness.

19. Marketplace Marketing

Marketplace marketing can help products gain:

Visibility

Search placement

Discovery

Conversion

However, marketplace marketing occurs in highly competitive environments. Potential challenges include:

Price competition

Promotional pressure

Competitor visibility

Platform fees

Limited customer ownership

Marketplace marketing should therefore be evaluated against both revenue and economics.

20. Direct Marketing

The company website provides greater control over direct customer relationships. Potential direct marketing opportunities include:

Email

Personalised offers

Product recommendations

Lifecycle messaging

Bundling

Retargeting

Loyalty activity

Direct marketing can be especially useful for existing customers because the company has more information about their previous behaviour.

21. Seasonal Marketing

Seasonal campaigns can create significant demand during relevant purchasing periods. Potential uses include:

Product promotions

Gift-oriented offers

Category campaigns

Bundles

Limited-time promotions

However, seasonal demand should not automatically be interpreted as sustainable underlying growth. Participants should distinguish between:

22. Discounting

Discounts can increase:

Conversion

Demand

Product visibility

Short-term sales

But discounts can also create:

Lower realised revenue per unit

Margin pressure

Customer price sensitivity

Promotional dependency

Channel conflict

The company therefore expects discount-led strategies to explain the economics behind the incremental sales.

“More discount is not automatically a sustainable marketing strategy.”

23. Campaign Performance

Campaign performance should be evaluated across several dimensions. Potential metrics include:

Spend

Revenue

Orders

Return on spend

Conversion

Customer acquisition

Repeat behaviour

Customer value

Incremental revenue

No single metric should be interpreted in isolation.

24. Marketing and Customer Quality

A campaign can generate many customers while still producing weak long-term value. Marketing should therefore consider:

Who was acquired?

What did they buy?

How much did they spend?

Did they return?

Did they buy complementary products?

How expensive were they to acquire?

Customer quality matters because acquisition creates future obligations as well as immediate revenue.

25. Marketing and Product Portfolio

Marketing should be connected to product strategy. A product can require different marketing depending on its role. Examples:

Growing category — potentially scale acquisition.

Mature category — improve efficiency / retention.

Declining category — reposition / target selectively.

Complementary accessory — cross-sell.

Specialist product — targeted segment marketing.

The product's role should therefore inform the campaign objective.

26. Marketing Experimentation

The company supports controlled experimentation. A marketing test may vary:

Audience

Message

Offer

Product

Channel

Budget

Timing

The test should define:

Control or comparison group where appropriate

Target population

Intervention

Budget

Measurement period

Success criterion

Experiments are particularly useful when historical data cannot conclusively establish causation.

27. Marketing Failure Modes

Common mistakes include:

28. Marketing Strategic Opportunities

Potential marketing-led growth strategies include:

Reallocation of existing spend

Customer reactivation

Retention programmes

Cross-sell campaigns

Product-specific campaigns

Segment-specific campaigns

Channel-specific optimisation

Website conversion improvement

Marketplace optimisation

Bundling

Personalisation

Experimentation

No one approach is predetermined.

29. Marketing and the ■10 Lakh Challenge

The company has an additional implementation budget of:

■10,00,000 (■10 lakh)

Marketing strategies should therefore distinguish between:

A recommendation that technically fits within ■10 lakh but requires unlimited recurring advertising spend is not necessarily financially disciplined. Participants should explain how the available budget is used and what happens after the initial implementation.

30. Marketing Principle

The company does not seek to maximise marketing activity. It seeks to maximise the value created by marketing resources. The core question is:

“Where can marketing create the greatest sustainable incremental commercial impact?”

The answer may involve:

More spending
Less spending
Reallocation
Better targeting
Better timing
Better product selection
Better customer selection
Better offers
Better measurement

31. Final Marketing Principle

Marketing should be treated as a system connecting:

A strong marketing strategy identifies where changing one or more of these elements can create meaningful incremental business value.

Wireless Earbuds→Power Bank→Fast Charger

Smart Watch→Power Bank→Fast Charger→Wireless Earbuds

Mechanical Keyboard→Wireless Mouse

Bluetooth Speaker→Power Bank

AWARENESS↓INTEREST↓CONSIDERATION↓CONVERSION↓PURCHASE↓REPEAT PURCHASE↓

Marketing channel≠Transaction channel

Temporary demand acceleration vs. Structural demand improvement

Increasing spend without identifying the bottleneck
If the problem is conversion, more traffic may not solve it.

Optimising ROAS without considering scale
An efficient campaign may be too small to materially affect total sales.

Acquiring customers without retention
This can create a costly cycle of replacing customers rather than developing them.

Over-discounting
This may increase sales while damaging economics.

Targeting everyone
Broad targeting may waste budget when stronger customer-product fits exist.

Treating attribution as causation
Attributed sales do not automatically represent incremental sales.

Required implementation cost and Ongoing variable spend

CUSTOMER+PRODUCT+MESSAGE+CHANNEL+TIMING+BUDGET+CONVERSION+